Yuwen Lu

Contact

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yuwen.io

Twitter/X

Google Scholar

Education

2021 - Current

Ph.D. Computer Science & Engineering

University of Notre Dame

Advisor: Toby Jia-Jun Li

2020 - 2021

Master, Human-Computer Interaction

Carnegie Mellon University

2016 - 2020

B.Eng, Software Engineering

Dalian University of Technology

Highlights

2026

Best Paper Honorable Mention, CHI

The top academic conference in Human Computer Interaction

Top 5% of accepted papers

2024

Best Paper, CSCW Conference

Top academic conference in Human Computer Interaction

Top 1% of accepted papers

2024

Notre Dame-IBM Tech Ethics Hackathon

3rd Place

2022 - 2024

Lucy Scholars Fellowship

Lucy Institute of Data and Society

2022 - 2024

CHI Workshops on Computational UI

Organized 3 successful workshops on computational approaches for understanding generating, and adapting user interfaces

Experience

Oct 2025 - Current — San Francisco, CA

Krea AI

Design Engineer

Building the Krea AI web app to support creative control with AI models, conduct user interviews & analyze analytics to understand latent user needs

May 2025 - Sept 2025 — San Francisco, CA

Midjourney

Visiting Researcher, Storytelling Lab

Building an iOS APP **Seep** that turns personal daily journals into visual stories, to support reflections and wellbeing (in Alpha testing)

May 2024 - Sept 2024 — Seattle. WA

Apple, AIML Research

Research Intern, UI Understanding Group

- Led project **Misty**: AI-powered UI prototyping through interactive conceptual blending, using multimodal AI to support rapid UI prototyping
- Paper featured on Apple ML Research and accepted at CHI 2025 with potential product applications

July 2023 - Dec 2023 — Cambridge, MA

Google, Material Design

Student Researcher

- Prototyped novel algorithms for design guideline violation check with AI models, focusing on Material Design guideline adoption at Google
- Published case study on AI adoption in UI linting (CHI 2024) with ongoing internal adoption

Projects

May 2024 - Sept 2024 — Work done during internship at Apple

Misty: UI Prototyping Through Interactive Conceptual Blending (Demo)

Lead Researcher

- Designed and developed novel interactions for UI prototyping with frontier AI models, implemented with Next.js, GPT-4o
- Explored direct manipulation techniques, e.g. drag-and-drop, to support borrowing inspirations from references, as an alternative to prompting
- Paper accepted at CHI 2025 with concrete product impact at Apple

Aug 2021 - Apr 2024

Crepe: A Mobile Screen Data Collector Using Graph Query

Lead Researcher, CHI 2026 Best Paper Honorable Mention

- Designed and Built an Android App that supports precise data collection of screen text data for algorithm auditing
- Used a novel Graph Query algorithm and Android Accessibility API to parse and retrieve the target data
- Achieved high data collection accuracy (F1 score 96.0%) with low battery consumption in the background

May 2023 - Sept 2023

Dark Pita: A Browser Extension Against Dark Patterns

Lead Researcher, Team of 4

- Developed browser extension enabling users to understand and customize to avoid manipulative website designs (i.e. “dark patterns”)
- Built using Vue.js, Tailwind CSS, and Firebase, code open sourced
- Won **Best Paper Award** at CSCW 2024 (top 1% of accepted papers)